

Open Workplace Health Standard

Workplace Wellbeing Question Bank

Version 0.1.0, updated 2026-07-11. Structure mapped from the What Works Centre for Wellbeing Workplace Wellbeing Question Bank (July 2020); item wording taken from each primary source under the licence recorded per item. Guidance text CC BY 4.0; dataset structure Apache 2.0.

85 items across 13 topic groups; 4 verified and rendered with wording.

Wellbeing and satisfaction

Outcome measures of how people rate their lives and their work overall (ONS personal well-being, satisfaction, positive affect).

aps-life-satisfaction Overall life satisfaction

"Overall, how satisfied are you with your life nowadays?"

Scale: 0 to 10, where 0 is 'not at all' and 10 is 'completely'. Source: ONS personal well-being questions (Annual Population Survey). Copyright status: OGL. Verification: verified. Benchmark: 7.45 (mean out of 10), year ending March 2023 (ONS).

aps-worthwhile Sense that life is worthwhile

"Overall, to what extent do you feel that the things you do in your life are worthwhile?"

Scale: 0 to 10, where 0 is 'not at all' and 10 is 'completely'. Source: ONS personal well-being questions (Annual Population Survey). Copyright status: OGL. Verification: verified. Benchmark: 7.73 (mean out of 10), year ending March 2023 (ONS).

aps-happiness Happiness yesterday

"Overall, how happy did you feel yesterday?"

Scale: 0 to 10, where 0 is 'not at all' and 10 is 'completely'. Source: ONS personal well-being questions (Annual Population Survey). Copyright status: OGL. Verification: verified. Benchmark: 7.39 (mean out of 10), year ending March 2023 (ONS).

aps-anxiety Anxiety yesterday

"Overall, how anxious did you feel yesterday?"

Scale: 0 to 10, where 0 is 'not at all anxious' and 10 is 'completely anxious'. Source: ONS personal well-being questions (Annual Population Survey). Copyright status: OGL. Verification: verified. Benchmark: 3.23 (mean out of 10), year ending March 2023 (ONS).

ses-job-satisfaction Overall job satisfaction

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 1 to 7 (completely dissatisfied to completely satisfied). Source: Skills and Employment Survey 2017. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

perma-joy Positive affect at work (joy)

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: PERMA-Profiler. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

oecd-positive-outlook Positive outlook

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ess-wlb-satisfaction Satisfaction with work-life balance

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: European Social Survey. Copyright status: ESS. Verification: unverified.

Health and functioning

Self-rated health, work-related ill health, and mental well-being state.

aps-self-rated-health Self-rated general health

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (very good to very bad). Source: ONS personal well-being questions (Annual Population Survey). Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-work-health-risk Perceived health or safety risk from work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

nhs-msk Musculoskeletal problems attributed to work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

nhs-work-stress-illness Work-related stress reported as illness

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

who5-cheerful WHO-5: cheerful and in good spirits

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 5 (all of the time to at no time). Source: WHO-5 Well-Being Index. Copyright status: WHO CC BY-NC-SA. Verification: unverified.

who5-calm WHO-5: calm and relaxed

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 5 (all of the time to at no time). Source: WHO-5 Well-Being Index. Copyright status: WHO CC BY-NC-SA. Verification: unverified.

who5-active WHO-5: active and vigorous

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 5 (all of the time to at no time). Source: WHO-5 Well-Being Index. Copyright status: WHO CC BY-NC-SA. Verification: unverified.

who5-fresh WHO-5: woke up fresh and rested

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 5 (all of the time to at no time). Source: WHO-5 Well-Being Index. Copyright status: WHO CC BY-NC-SA. Verification: unverified.

who5-interest WHO-5: daily life filled with interesting things

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 5 (all of the time to at no time). Source: WHO-5 Well-Being Index. Copyright status: WHO CC BY-NC-SA. Verification: unverified.

nhs-presenteeism Presenteeism: attending work while unwell

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

nhs-presenteeism-pressure Pressure to attend work while unwell

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

Health behaviours

Health-related behaviours such as physical activity and diet.

us-physical-activity Physical activity days per week

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 7 days. Source: Understanding Society (UK Household Longitudinal Study), Wave 9. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

us-diet Fruit and vegetable consumption

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: frequency. Source: Understanding Society (UK Household Longitudinal Study), Wave 9. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

Job demands and intensity

Workload, pace, deadlines, emotional demand, unsocial or long hours, and physical load. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Demands domain.

csps-workload Acceptable workload

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-deadlines Working to tight deadlines

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 7-point (all of the time to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-time-enough Enough time to do the job

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-hide-feelings Required to hide feelings

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-night-work Frequency of night work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: days per month or never. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-long-days Frequency of long (10+ hour) days

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: days per month or never. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-painful-positions Tiring or painful positions

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 7-point (all of the time to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-repetitive-movements Repetitive hand or arm movements

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 7-point (all of the time to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

Control, autonomy and skill use

Discretion over work and the chance to learn and use skills. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Control domain.

ewcs-apply-ideas Able to apply own ideas

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-consulted Consulted before objectives are set

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oecd-influence-decisions Influence over important decisions

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-work-methods Can choose or change work methods

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-learning Learning new things at work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-training-employer Employer-provided training

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-training-otj On-the-job training

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

csps-ld-access Access to learning and development

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

csps-challenge Sufficiently challenged by work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

ses-skills-use Opportunity to use knowledge and skills

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Skills and Employment Survey 2017. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

Support and relationships

Support from managers and colleagues, feedback, recognition and team working. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Support and Relationships domains.

perma-relationships Satisfaction with working relationships

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: PERMA-Profiler. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-manager-support Manager provides help and support

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-manager-respect Manager respects you

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-manager-recognition Manager gives praise and recognition

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-manager-feedback Manager gives useful feedback

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-manager-development Manager encourages development

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

csps-team Team improves the service together

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-colleague-support Colleagues provide help and support

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-colleague-relations Gets on well with colleagues

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

Fair treatment and conduct

Fair treatment and freedom from bullying and harassment. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Relationships domain.

ewcs-fair-treatment Treated fairly at work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-bullying-harassment Experience of bullying or harassment

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

Role, purpose and recognition

Role clarity, meaning, contribution, direction and recognition. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Role domain.

nhs-values-alignment Values aligned with the organisation

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

csps-clear-objectives Clear organisational objectives

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

csps-contribution Own work contributes to objectives

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-knows-expectations Knows what is expected at work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

perma-direction Sense of direction

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: PERMA-Profiler. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-motivates-performance Organisation motivates good performance

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oeed-recognition Receives deserved recognition

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-work-well-done Feeling of work well done

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

perma-achieve-goals Achieves important goals

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: PERMA-Profiler. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-useful-work Doing useful work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oeed-help-others Opportunity to help others

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

perma-absorption Absorption and engagement in work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 0 to 10. Source: PERMA-Profiler. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

Job security and change

Security of the job, prospects, and how change is handled. Aligns to the HSE Management Standards Change domain.

ewcs-advancement Opportunities for career advancement

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-job-insecurity Perceived risk of job loss

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oecd-undesirable-change Expecting an undesirable change at work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

csps-change-managed Change is managed well

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

Working time and the work-home boundary

Scheduling, flexibility, recovery and detachment from work outside hours.

iwbi-commute Commuting stress

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: WELL Building Standard. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-flexibility Flexibility for personal or family matters

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 4-point (very easy to very difficult). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oecd-breaks Sufficient breaks

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (always to never). Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ewcs-free-time-work Working in free time

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (daily to never). Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

ses-worry-after-work Worrying about work after hours

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 6-point (never to all of the time). Source: Skills and Employment Survey 2017. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ses-unwinding Difficulty unwinding after work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 6-point (never to all of the time). Source: Skills and Employment Survey 2017. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

ess-fatigue-home Too tired after work for home tasks

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (never to always). Source: European Social Survey. Copyright status: ESS. Verification: unverified.

Physical environment and resources

The adequacy of tools, equipment and facilities for the job.

csps-tools Has the tools needed for the job

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

oeed-facilities Adequate facilities for health and well-being

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

Financial security

Pay adequacy, financial security and resilience.

ewcs-pay-appropriate Paid appropriately for the work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: European Working Conditions Survey 2015 (6th wave). Copyright status: Eurofound. Verification: unverified.

oeed-future-living Confidence about future standard of living

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 4-point (very to not at all confident). Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

us-managing-financially Managing financially

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point (living comfortably to very difficult). Source: Understanding Society (UK Household Longitudinal Study), Wave 9. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

fincap-resilience Resilience to an unexpected bill

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: scenario response. Source: Financial Capability Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.

Organisational health culture and policy

Whether the organisation acts on, signposts and normalises support for health and well-being.

nhs-org-action-wellbeing Organisation acts on health and well-being

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: yes / no. Source: NHS Staff Survey. Copyright status: NHS. Verification: unverified.

mh-know-support-access Knows how to access mental well-being support

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

mh-org-supports Organisation supports staff with mental health problems

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

mh-inclusive Inclusive environment for mental health

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

mh-confidence-discuss Confidence discussing mental health at work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: OECD Guidelines on Measuring Subjective Well-being. Copyright status: permission required; none requested. Verification: unverified.

csps-recommend-workplace Would recommend as a place to work

Wording held at source; not reproduced in this release.

Scale: 5-point agreement. Source: Civil Service People Survey. Copyright status: OGL. Verification: unverified.